

DS Group's 'Project Saamya' is fostering a gender equitable society through young boys in the communities of Noida

This special programme has branched out in three communities of Noida (NCR) including Mamura, Basai and Garhi Chaukhandi

The programme has already facilitated more than 350 young boys and has expanded further to other locations

DS Group's initiative, 'Saamya,' is a pioneering effort aimed at fostering gender equity by sensitizing young boys aged 7-11. The comprehensive program, spanning communities in Noida, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, and Madhya Pradesh, addresses gender-related issues through a range of activities, workshops, training sessions, and discussions.

The larger objective of Saamya is to instill values of empathy, respect, and gender equity in young boys, recognizing that behavioral change is a long-term commitment. By working closely with boys at an early age, DS Group believes that a substantial impact can be made towards transforming societal norms related to gender.

The initiative addresses the deep-rooted manifestations of gender-related ideas and practices across society. It acknowledges the impact of external influences, incomplete knowledge, and exposure to inappropriate content on young boys, who may perceive violence as a means of exercising power in relationships. Saamya seeks to counter these influences by providing accurate information and promoting positive behaviors.

Encouraging and supporting the capacity of men and boys in fostering gender equality is a key aspect of Saamya. The program recognizes the potential contributions of men and boys as agents for change, particularly in decision-making roles and positions of power. Saamya is dedicated to breaking down discriminatory barriers and dismantling practices that impede progress toward gender equality, striving to create a more inclusive and empowering environment for positive impact.

Aligned with Jean Piaget's stages of cognitive development, Saamya targets the Concrete Operational stage, where children absorb information and act upon it as they grow. By intervening at this crucial stage, Saamya becomes a preventive measure, addressing issues before they become deeply ingrained during adolescence.